

Board 1
 East Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 9 3
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ Q J 6 5
 ♣ A 8 3 2

N
 W E
 S

♠ Q J 8 6 4
 ♥ A T 9 8 3
 ♦ 3
 ♣ 7 6

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2 ♦]

A perfect Michaels example; 5-5 in the Majors and 9 points. You bid 2 ♦ and partner says 2 ♠. What do you bid next? [BID pass]

[show NS]

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠		
All Pass			

2 ♠ by North
 you have for his ♠ suit, he doesn't **HAVE** a ♠ suit, he is just supporting yours. In other words, you pass.

You have a rather minimum Michaels type hand and you asked partner to choose a Major suit. He chose ♠s. But don't start thinking about what great support

Board 2

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A T 8 6 3
♥ A T 9 7 4
♦ 8 6
♣ 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 5
♥ K 8 3
♦ A J T 5
♣ 9 7 6

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
All Pass			
2 ♥ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2 ♥]

[show NS]

You have a fair hand with a guaranteed 8-card fit in either Major. You are not, however, strong enough to jump the bidding. So you bid 2 ♥, which is passed out.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ A 6 4 2

♥ Q 8 7 3

♦ Q 3

♣ A 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 5

♥ 9

♦ K T 9 7 4

♣ K Q J 6 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	2NT

Pass 3♣

All Pass

3♣ by North
showed nothing more than minimum. So you pass.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2NT]

You have a pretty good hand for an Unusual Notrump, but not so good that you wouldn't use the convention. You bid 2NT and partner says 3♣. What do you say next? [BID pass]

[show NS]

As mentioned, you have a pretty good hand, but partner only bid because you forced him to and he

Board 4

West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ 9 6
♥ 4
♦ K Q J 8 4
♣ K Q T 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 7 5
♥ A J 9 7 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ J 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
All Pass			
3 ♦ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♦]

[show NS]

Your best suit is ♥s. But partner didn't ask you to bid ♥s, he asked you to pick a Minor. You know you will have an 8-card fit in ♦s so you take the safe approach and bid 3 ♦. Everybody passes.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ 8 6 3
♥ K 7 5 3 2
♦ A 9 7 5
♣ Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7
♥ J T 9 8 4
♦ 6
♣ K J T 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♥	1♠	2♠
All Pass			

4♥ by North

get lucky and make this but it looks like the other guys are cold for 4♠. Even if partner loses 2♥ tricks and goes down 1 it will turn out to be a good sacrifice.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♠]

Of course you bid a Michaels Cue-Bid of 2♠.

Partner says 4♥. What do you bid now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Partner's jump might indicate he has a really good hand, or he might just have a really good fit. You certainly don't have the strength to make another move so you pass. A good thing, too. Partner might

Board 6

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 7 4

♥ 6

♦ J 9 8 7 3

♣ A Q T 8 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A K T 6

♥ A K J 9

♦ K 6

♣ K J 2

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3NT]

[show NS]

You have no idea what you can make with this hand. Slam in one of the minors may be possible, but maybe not. You decide to try 3NT.

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Board 7
 East Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 9 3
 ♥ A 6
 ♦ Q 9 8 4 2
 ♣ K Q J

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 7
 ♥ Q J 9 8 4
 ♦ K J T 5 3
 ♣ 2

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2NT]

With the two lowest unbid suits you bid 2NT. Partner jumps to 4♦. What do you bid? [BID pass]

[show NS]

West	North	East	South
		1♣	2NT
Pass	4♦		
All Pass			

4♦ by North
 weaker. It is strictly a judgement call and we decide to pass.

Partner probably has a good hand, but he might just be preempting. Assuming he is inviting you to bid game you have a tough decision. You are not very strong but you might have been a couple of points

As you can see, **IF** they open the lead with a ♣, and **IF** the ♥ finesse then works, you can make 5♦.

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 9 8 7 4
♥ Q J T 9 6
♦ 5
♣ 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J T 6
♥ 7 4
♦ A 7 6
♣ A T 9 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	2 ♦	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♠]

[show NS]

As you have figured out by now, using Michaels Cue-Bids / Unusual Notrump is sometimes hard to tie down. Here you have 13/14 points and if you figure partner for 9 that won't be enough for game. But, those two Minor Aces are worth a lot when you figure partner has only 3 Minor suit cards.

So let's say you decide to just invite with 3 ♠. Partner takes you to game.

You will surely make this game if trumps split 2-2. If they don't then you will have to hope for a defensive mistake.

Board 9
East Deals
None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ K Q J 7
♥ 6
♦ 9 7 4
♣ K 8 6 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T
♥ Q J 9 8 4
♦ K J T 5 3
♣ J 2

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	2 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
All Pass			
3 ♦ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2 ♠]

With 5 cards in the "other" Major and a 5-card Minor you bid 2 ♠, Michaels of course. Partner bids 2NT. What do you say next? [BID 3 ♦]

[show NS]

Is it possible that partner wants to play Notrump? Not at all. He hates ♥s and wants you to bid your Minor suit. So you say 3 ♦ and he passes.

Board 10
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K Q
♥ A K Q 8 3
♦ Q J T 5 4
♣ 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 6
♥ 7 4
♦ K 7 6 3
♣ A T 9 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	5 ♦
All Pass			

5 ♦ by South

trumps. I'm a lot better than that.", then you will accept the invitation. So you bid 5 ♦ and everybody passes.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♦]

Partner asked you to choose between ♥s and ♦s so you bid 3 ♦. He then raises you to 4 ♦. What do you bid? [BID 5 ♦]

[show NS]

If you say to yourself "I only have 7 HCP" then you might pass. But if you say "Partner invited me to bid game, even though I might have no points and only 3

Board 11
East Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K T 9 3

♥ J 6 5 2

♦ K 6

♣ K Q 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A Q J 6 5

♥ 9

♦ A Q T 5 3

♣ 6 3

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Partner's cue-bid shows a limit-raise or better in ♠s. So you bid 4♠ without the blink of an eye.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 1♠]

With 5 cards in the "other" Major and a 5-card Minor suit this looks like an ideal Michaels Cue-Bid, right? No, not really. While it would not be a capital offense to bid 2♥ here, it generally works out better with 13-16 point hands to just overcall in your higher-ranking suit. You bid 1♠. Partner responds 2♥. What do you bid? [BID 4♠]

[show NS]

Board 12

West Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ A T 9 8 3

♥ 8

♦ 7 5

♣ Q J T 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6

♥ K 6 4 2

♦ K T 9 3

♣ K 8 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	2 ♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3 ♣		
All Pass			
3 ♣ by North			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2NT]

Partner is 5-5 in ♠s and one of the Minor suits. Forget ♠s, you want him to bid the Minor. So you bid 2NT. Partner says 3 ♣. What do you bid now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Partner only made a minimum bid, so you have no choice but to pass.

Board 13

East Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ 7 6 2

♥ J 9 5

♦ Q J 8

♣ 7 5 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 8 5 3

♥ K Q T 7 4

♦ 5

♣ A 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by North

to bid. Any bid at all by you at this point will show 17+ points, so you just raise to 3♥. Partner has a weak hand and passes.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♦]

With 18 points and 5-5 Major suits you are up in the high-level Michaels category. You bid 2♦ and partner responds 2♥. What do you bid next? [BID 3♥]

[show NS]

Yes, you have a high-level Michaels hand but don't get carried away. Remember that you forced partner to bid. Any bid at all by you at this point will show 17+ points, so you just raise to 3♥. Partner has a weak hand and passes.

Board 14

West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 9 4

♥ A T 9 6 4

♦ K Q 6 5 2

♣ 8

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ Q J T 8 7 6 5

♥ 8 3

♦ 7 4

♣ A 6

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2NT	Pass	3 ♠
All Pass			
3 ♠ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♠]

[show NS]

Partner wants you to bid ♥s or ♦s. You figure that in either of the red suits you will have a 7-card fit. You hope to do better than that in ♠s. So you bid 3 ♠ and everybody passes.

Board 15

East Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ J 9 4 3

♥ J 6

♦ T 7 6 4

♣ 9 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q T 6 2

♥ A K Q 7 4

♦ 5

♣ A 3

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♣]

You have 20 points and two good 5-card Majors so you bid a Michaels 2♣. Partner responds 2♠. What do you say next? [BID 4♠]

[show NS]

West	North	East	South
------	-------	------	-------

		1♣	2♣
--	--	----	----

Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
------	----	------	----

All Pass

4♠ by North

your hand you only need to find partner with ♠ J x x to have a good shot at game. So go ahead and bid 4♠.

Partner may have as few as zero points and as many as 13 or so. You **COULD** bid an invitational 3♠, but if he has only 5 or 6 points he will pass. Looking at

Will you look at that. Partner has only 2 points, but what great ones to have!

Board 16

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 9 8 5 2
♥ A 9 4 3 2
♦ T 5
♣ 9

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6
♥ K Q T 8
♦ 7 4 2
♣ A K 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	2 ♦	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 4 ♥]

[show NS]

Partner has 5 of each Major suit so you know of a good 9-card ♥ fit. You have a nice hand and must decide between inviting with 3 ♥ or bidding the game on your own. You decide to bid the game so you say 4 ♥ and everybody passes.

Board 17

East Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 7 3
 ♥ A K
 ♦ A Q 6 3
 ♣ T 8 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4
 ♥ 6
 ♦ K 8 7 5 2
 ♣ Q J 9 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	2NT
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	5 ♣		
All Pass			
5 ♣ by South partner raises to 5 ♣.			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2NT]

This is a really good hand for Unusual Notrump. You bid 2NT and partner says 3 ♠. What do you say now? [BID 4 ♣]

[show NS]

Partner apparently has a big hand. His cue-bid is forcing, and probably means he wants to be in game. But for now you can just show your minimum strength and give a suit preference. You bid 4 ♣ and

Board 18
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q J 7 5 3
♥ A 9 8 4 2
♦ K 5
♣ 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 4
♥ J 6
♦ Q T 9 7 4 2
♣ K 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2 ♣	3 ♣	
All Pass			
3 ♣ by West			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Many times at Bridge you want to fight for the contract. This isn't one of them. With 6 HCP and only four cards total in partner's two suits just let the opponents have it. You pass.

Board 19
East Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 7

♥ 6 2

♦ A 6 4

♣ A K Q 8 7 4 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ Q T 6 5 2

♥ K Q 9 7 3

♦ 7

♣ J 9

West	North	East	South
Pass	3♣	1♦	2♦
All Pass			
3♣ by North you would be better in ♣s. So you pass.			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♦]

With two 5-card Majors of course you bid 2♦.
Partner responds 3♣. What do you say now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

This wasn't according to your script. Partner was supposed to choose a Major. The reason he didn't, of course, is that he didn't like either one and figured

Board 20
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K J T 5 2

♥ A 9 7 4 3

♦ 6 2

♣ T

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ Q 8 7 4

♥ T 6 5

♦ 7

♣ A 9 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	2 ♦	3 ♦	3 ♠

All Pass
3 ♠ by South

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♠]

[show NS]

You don't have a great hand but you **DO** have 4 ♠s. So don't let the opponents have a 3-level contract when your side has 9 ♠s. Bid 3 ♠.

Note: See the Law of Total Tricks Lesson on this topic.